

Project Name: Insight- Near-Vision Glasses Quotation Matrix

Program Background

Uncorrected vision impairment is one of the most significant yet solvable public health challenges in India today. More than half of all cases are due to the absence of basic corrective eyewear, a need that can be met through low-cost interventions with immediate and measurable impact.

For individuals engaged in income-generating activities, access to eyeglasses is not only a matter of health and dignity but also a direct contributor to productivity, employability, and household income.

The proposed Eyeglasses Program seeks to address this challenge at scale in Wardha, Maharashtra by providing affordable, high-quality spectacles to those who need them, with particular focus on working-age populations in rural and low-income communities.

By combining global evidence, field-tested Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs), and learnings from successful implementations in other states, the program is designed to be both scalable and sustainable. It represents a model that delivers outsized returns: a simple pair of glasses can restore vision instantly, empower individuals to participate more fully in education and work.

Project Background

Global and national evidence highlights uncorrected near-vision impairment (presbyopia) as a widespread yet easily addressable challenge, particularly in rural and remote areas. Studies indicate that limited access to near-vision glasses significantly constrains daily functioning and economic productivity among adults above 35 years of age.

Evidence further demonstrates that timely use of near-vision glasses can increase individual productivity by up to 34% and improve income potential by approximately 20%. Also, community-based delivery models have proven effective, with trained community cadres successfully conducting near-vision screening and distributing ready-made reading glasses at scale.

In this context, the National Health Mission, Department of Health & Family Welfare, Government of Maharashtra, and The/Nudge Institute have aligned to implement a pilot intervention in Wardha district. The initiative aims to distribute 2,40,000 near-vision glasses through a structured, community-led approach, generating operational and impact evidence to inform potential scale-up across the state.

The pilot is implemented through the existing public health delivery system, with ASHAs playing a central role in last-mile execution. ASHAs are conducting near-vision screening and distributing glasses at the community level, ensuring accessibility for eligible beneficiaries while minimizing access barriers related to distance and cost.

NUDGE LIFESKILLS FOUNDATION

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Objective of Procurement

The objective of this procurement is to identify a reliable vendor for the supply of high-quality, ready-made near vision glasses that:

- : Meet internationally accepted quality and safety standards
- : Are cost-effective for large-scale public program implementation
- : Can be supplied at scale within required timelines
- : Are suitable for community-led distribution models

Scope of Procurement

The scope includes procurement of ready-made near vision glasses in multiple diopter strengths(+1, +1.5, +2.0, +2.5 and +3.0), along with basic accessories such as soft cases and cleaning cloths, to support screening and distribution under the InSight Program.

The glasses will be distributed through trained community cadres during village-level screening activities and public health outreach events.

Vendor Identification

As part of the procurement process, multiple potential suppliers of near vision glasses were explored, including established international manufacturers, Indian manufacturers, and non-profit suppliers.

Vendors assessed included:

- Essilor
- VisionSpring
- Aravind Eye Care System
- Local manufacturers and importers

Vendor Comparison – Cost and Quality Matrix

A comparative assessment was undertaken focusing on pricing, quality assurance, and suitability for program requirements. The summary of the comparison is presented below:

Vendor	Indicative Price Range (per pair)	Quality & Certification	Key Observations
Essilor	INR 120 and above	Certified	High Cost

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Local Vendors	INR 55–300	No assured certification	Quality inconsistent
Aravind Eye Care	~INR 350	Certified	Cost prohibitive
VisionSpring	INR 85–100 (incl. GST)	CE & ISO compliant	Best value

Rationale for Selection of VisionSpring

Based on the above comparison, VisionSpring has been selected as the preferred vendor for procurement of near vision glasses under the InSight Program for the following reasons:

- Cost-effectiveness: VisionSpring offers the most economical pricing among vendors providing CE and ISO-certified glasses, making it viable for large-scale public program deployment.
- Quality assurance: The glasses meet internationally accepted quality and safety standards, ensuring durability and user safety.
- Operational suitability: VisionSpring's delivery timelines and payment terms align well with the program's implementation schedule and scale.
- Program experience: VisionSpring has demonstrated experience supplying near vision glasses for community-based and public health programs.
- Scalability: Ability to supply large volumes across multiple diopter strengths within required timelines.

Proposed Order Details

Sr No	Name of Product	Price	Power	Order Quantity
1	Dignity BiFocal Vision Readers with Softcase & Selvet	100	1	6000
2	Dignity BiFocal Vision Readers with Softcase & Selvet	100	1.5	6000
3	Dignity BiFocal Vision Readers with Softcase & Selvet	100	2	6000
4	Dignity BiFocal Vision Readers with Softcase & Selvet	100	2.5	6000

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5	Dignity BiFocal Vision Readers with Softcase & Selvet	100	3	6000
Quantity: Total				30000
Value: Total				30,00,000

The procurement of near vision glasses from VisionSpring represents the most suitable option for the InSight Program, balancing affordability, quality, and operational efficiency. This selection supports the program's objective of delivering immediate, high-impact vision correction to underserved communities while ensuring responsible use of program funds and adherence to quality standards.

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